Procedural Shapes and a Moving Policy Rollout

Technical Report

Submission ID: Anonymous submission

Abstract: We build every object shape from the stereo video alone, as simple procedural parts sized from monocular depth, and produce every pose by rolling out a policy trained with reinforcement learning in simulation. On nineteen of the twenty scored episodes the policy holds the object at its estimated starting pose. On episode 38 a policy trained from scratch follows an object path tracked in the video. That one moving episode lifts the leaderboard AUC from 0.307 (all static) to 0.323 and SP-SR from 0.15 to 0.20. The main finding is where the score goes: the objects move in every clip, and even the true starting poses held still reach only 0.53 AUC.

1. Introduction

Track 3 asks for a mesh of each manipulated object and a per-frame object pose, where the poses must come from policies rolled out in simulation by the official evaluator [2, 3]. Our entry has three parts: shapes measured from video with MoGe-2 [5]; static policies in FlashCHORD [1] that place each object where the video shows it at the start; and, on one episode, a policy that moves the object along a path recovered from the video. We report what each part scores, what it costs, and where the evidence is weak.

2. Approach

Shapes. For each object we pool MoGe-2 depth above the table inside the object's mask over many frames, drop observations that are merged with another object or clipped by the image edge, and size a procedural shape, whose parts we specify by hand per object, to the measured extents. Public scans of the training objects guided how we designed and selected this method; no scan geometry, dimension or template enters any submitted mesh or simulated asset. Pretrained Hunyuan3D-2mini shapes [4] for the pot (episode 5) and the pitcher (episode 20) lowered local CD-O, but we had no tested mapping from their frame to the simulation's, so the counted file keeps the procedural shapes.

Static poses (19 episodes). Stereo mask centroids place each object on the table with 1 cm clearance; heading is unknown except on episode 19, where it comes from registering a public scan to the stereo points. Per-episode policies, trained by reinforcement learning with box hands that do not act and a 512-step budget, are exported through the unedited evaluator. Their objects stay where they start, so these rollouts are learned placements, not learned manipulation.

Moving pose (episode 38). Masks come from SAM2.1 and Grounding DINO with a box-prompt rule fixed before tracking. Camera motion comes from bundle adjustment on background features; stereo depth and silhouette fitting then track our own video-derived pan mesh frame by frame. No scan or motion capture enters the tracking; one constant taken from a public scan sets the object's axes and handle convention and creates no motion. FlashSAC trains a policy from scratch in FlashCHORD to carry the object along this path: 1,024 parallel worlds, one seed, 66.8M transitions. A fixed rigid grasp stands in for the human hand, which we do not recover; contact alone moves the object. Mass (0.3 kg) and inertia are example values, and the simulated pan is larger than measured (25.6 by 21.3 against 18.2 by 16.6 cm). The rollout is admitted only if it passes gates written before it ran: path-following gain $T \geq 0.5$, increment agreement $Q \geq 0.5$, mean error $E \leq 3$ cm and $\Theta \leq 15°$ against its own video path, first pose within 1 cm and 2°, and mask overlap (median IoU ≥ 0.60).

3. Experiments and Results

Can a policy follow a video path? Tuning episode 39 has motion capture, so we test the idea there (Table 1, old scorer, one clip, one seed). Held still, the pose scores 0.18 AUC. The tracked video path itself reaches 0.833. A policy trained on that video path reaches 0.775 after one run of about an hour on a 16 GB GPU; trained on motion capture instead it reaches 0.982, which shows how much is lost to the tracked path rather than to the policy.

Episode 39 (old scorer)	AUC	E cm	angle deg
Held still	0.18	16.43	51.08
Video path alone	0.833	2.16	8.57
Policy on motion capture	0.982	0.62	0.92
Policy on video path	0.775	2.67	8.31

Table 1: Tuning episode 39, poses aligned to motion capture at the first frame. E and angle are mean translation and rotation errors. The motion-capture policy uses information a real entry does not have.

Episode 38. The same pipeline passed every admission gate: $T = 1.026$, $Q = 0.973$, $E = 1.42$ cm, $\Theta = 1.59°$, first pose 0.30 cm and 0.27°, mask IoU median 0.778 with full coverage, and all 263 frames without a reset. These gates measure how well the policy follows the video path, not accuracy: episode 38 has no labels available to us. Training needed three attempts and at least 63 minutes in total. On the three spoon episodes (35, 36, 37) the same method stopped at its mask check (10.9, 8.8 and 0.7% of frames usable against the 90% rule), so they stay static. The other sixteen scored episodes have two objects, which this route does not yet handle.

Why static poses score low. On the eight training episodes our static poses score 0.277 AUC with the old scorer, and true starting poses held still score only 0.532. About half the metric is lost to motion that no static pose can follow; the rest is placement error, worst in heading. The scan-based heading on episode 19 was supported by one training episode (0.30 to 0.47 AUC).

Shapes. On ten public scans used for development, the pretrained pot and pitcher lowered local CD-O from 0.653 to 0.564 cm; the mesh-only pack with them scored 0.536 cm on the leaderboard, against 0.565 cm for our counted file with procedural shapes.

Scorer change. The organisers replaced the kit on 2 November; its pose metrics register the submitted mesh to the hidden scan. Our earlier numbers use the old scorer. Rechecked with the new scorer's code on public geometry, static training AUC is about 0.30 and episode 39's video policy 0.669; a box-like shape can register up to 180° off.

File	AUC	SP-SR	MP-SR	RPE	MPPE	CD-O
Static	0.307	0.15	0	20.11	14.62	0.566
38 moving	**0.323**	**0.20**	0	20.11	**14.30**	**0.565**

Table 2: Leaderboard, 4 November (RPE, MPPE, CD-O in cm). The moving file is our counted entry. Scores arrived after every method choice and were not used to tune anything.

Limits of the evidence. The tracker failed its first frozen rule and one amendment. A third, conditional rule was written after we saw the video-only checks on both pan clips, though before the single comparison against motion capture on 39; that breaks our own one-amendment rule and is weaker than validation planned in advance. Episode 39's first verdict was negative and became positive only after aligning the first pose, which its protocol did not specify; its labels were read twice for arithmetic, though the policy was scored once. Episode 38 failed a midpoint check ($T = 0.25$) and was resumed rather than restarted. Everything rests on one object type, one seed and a non-human grasp.

4. Conclusion

Static poses cap this task at about half the AUC, and a policy trained on a video-tracked path can move the object: 0.775 against 0.18 on the tuning clip, and a measured gain on the leaderboard from a single moving episode. **Economic viability:** one moving policy costs about an hour on one 16 GB GPU and needs no motion capture; cost at scale is not yet shown. **Data flywheel:** not shown; each episode is processed once. **Innovation:** the policy learns from a path tracked in ordinary stereo video, without recovering the human hand. **Complexity reduction:** the inputs are stereo video, fixed prompts and a procedural shape. Next steps are two-object scenes and spoon-sized objects.

References

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